

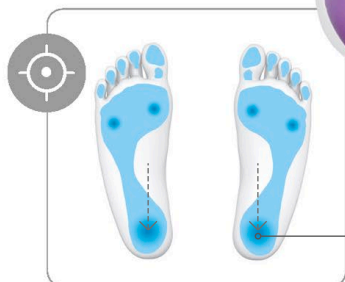


Increased lumbar load

Lifting your arms increases the load on your lumbar spine. This can be great to effectively strengthen the core muscles. However, for some people the force is so strong that they lose the integrity of the core and spine, causing lower back strain. If this happens, you can rest your hands on your hips.

Spinal extensors stabilize spine in neutral position

Hips are released back and down toward floor

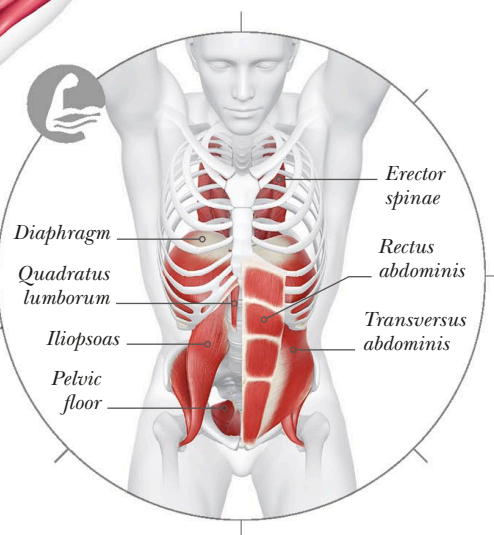


Pressure and balance

Bringing your weight back toward your heels can take pressure off your knees. Try spreading and lifting your toes, feeling your weight shift back. Then, place your toes down gently while keeping your weight back.

Biceps brachii lengthen to reach out arms and engage to stabilize

Brachioradialis is in a stretched position



Core strength

There are many definitions of what makes up the “core,” but it generally includes all of the abdominals, the pelvic floor, back muscles like the erector spinae, the respiratory diaphragm, and sometimes the iliopsoas. Asanas like Chair pose help develop core function and awareness, which can improve posture, balance, and functional movements throughout your day.

Toes are spread and relaxed, without curling or clenching

POSTERIOR-LATERAL VIEW